

CAPS Dealer Yield Program

A hypothetical product initiative for Credit Acceptance Corporation

Prepared by Badou Franck, MBA, PMP, PMI-PBA · Candidate, Senior Product Manager · September 2026

Purpose of this document. Rather than submit a résumé alone, this package shows how I would operate as a Senior Product Manager at Credit Acceptance. It is built from public information ([Q2 2026 earnings release](#), [Q2 2026 earnings call transcript](#), [Form 10-Q for the quarter ended June 30, 2026](#), [dealer interviews on CAPS workflow challenges](#) and [loan volume growth hurdles](#), the [CPO/CMO interview on CAPS strategy](#), and [company dealer materials](#)) and frames one realistic product initiative end to end: the strategy, the stakeholder communication and dealer engagement plans, the Jira backlog and timeline with GitHub-tracked development progress, the tools in scope, and the Visio cross-department interdependency maps. Everything is hypothetical and uses no non-public information.

Executive Brief

A working hypothesis built from public information - designed to show how I would think, validate, prioritize, and deliver as a Senior Product Manager, not to presume the answer before seeing Credit Acceptance's internal data.

Observed signal	Active dealer count is at record levels while average unit volume per active dealer has declined. The product opportunity is to increase yield from the installed dealer base, not only acquisition.
Working product hypothesis	Reduce dealer workflow friction so more approved applications become funded deals through CAPS.
Three product bets	1) Multi-Vehicle Deal Options; 2) Desking-Tool Intake Integration; 3) Dealer Yield Analytics & Enablement.
Success measure	Target a 5% lift in same-period dealer unit volume within two quarters of full rollout, with collection, compliance, and approval-latency guardrails intact.
Validation approach	Treat every element of the initiative as a hypothesis to validate in Discovery: dealer interviews, internal KPI baselines, EVA modeling, architecture review, Compliance partnership, and a controlled pilot.
First 30 days	Learn the enterprise before changing it. The onboarding plan at the end of this package is designed to confirm, revise, or replace this hypothesis using internal data and direct observation.

This is a hypothesis, not a recommendation made with internal data.

Table of Contents

[Executive Brief](#)

[1. What I learned about Credit Acceptance](#)

[The signal that shaped this project](#)

[Where the friction is \(dealer voice\)](#)

[Competitive landscape](#)

[2. The hypothetical initiative](#)

[Three workstreams](#)

[Out of scope](#)

[3. Product strategy](#)

[Customer definition](#)

[Strategic choices](#)

[Roadmap](#)

[4. Stakeholder communication strategy & plan](#)

[Stakeholder analysis \(power / interest\)](#)

[Communication plan](#)

[Dealer engagement strategy & plan](#)

[5. Proposed delivery operating model](#)

[Epics](#)

[Sample stories \(format used throughout\)](#)

[GitHub integration: development progress tracked automatically](#)

[6. Delivery plan & timeline \(Jira Plans\)](#)

[7. Tools in scope](#)

[8. Diagrams \(designed for MS Visio\)](#)

[Diagram A — Cross-department interdependency map \(cross-functional flowchart, swimlanes\)](#)

[Diagram B — End-to-end deal flow, current vs. future \(basic flowchart, two lanes\)](#)

[Diagram C — Integration context diagram \(block diagram\)](#)

[9. RAID starter register](#)

[10. First 30 Days — Validate or Replace the Hypothesis](#)

[10.1 Objectives and Day-30 deliverables](#)

[10.2 Track 1 — HR & Compliance training](#)

[10.3 Track 2 — Enterprise Analysis \(BABOK\)](#)

[10.4 Week-by-week plan](#)

[10.5 Interview guide \(same five questions for every one-on-one\)](#)

[10.6 Day-30 success criteria](#)

1. What I learned about Credit Acceptance

Credit Acceptance (NASDAQ: CACC) was [founded in 1972 by Donald Foss](#), the son of a used-car salesman, and is headquartered in Southfield, Michigan with roughly 2,400 employees. Foss led the company for four decades; today it is run by [Vinayak Hegde, Chief Executive Officer and President since November 2025](#), a former Amazon, Airbnb, and T-Mobile executive who succeeded long-time CEO Kenneth Booth — a signal that the board is prioritizing digital transformation and product. The company serves two customers at once: a nationwide network of independent and franchise automobile dealers, and the consumers those dealers sell to, [regardless of the consumer's credit history](#). Its distribution engine is CAPS (Credit Approval Processing System), a proprietary origination platform that returns an approval in roughly 30 seconds and lets dealers structure, contract, and fund the deal in one place. Revenue comes from two programs: Dealer Loans (portfolio program with holdback) and Purchased Loans (one-time purchase), and the Purchased Loan mix is rising (31.5% of units in Q2 2026 vs. 28.4% a year earlier).

The signal that shaped this project

Metric (Q2 2026 vs Q2 2025)	Value	What it tells a PM
Active dealers	11,004 (+3.3%) — second consecutive record	Enrollment/acquisition is working
Avg unit volume per active dealer	7.7 vs 8.0 (−3.8%)	Each dealer is producing less
Dealers active in both periods	6,860 dealers, volume −5.3%	The core installed base is shrinking in output
Dealers not active both periods	Volume +21.3%	Growth is coming from new dealers, not retained ones
Core-segment market share	4.9% vs 5.3% (low of 4.4% in Q4 2025)	Competitors (Westlake, Exeter, Santander, Octane) are taking share at the dealer desk
Monthly unit volume	June returned to YoY growth; July +28%	Momentum exists — the question is whether existing dealers ride it

Interpretation. The public signal suggests Credit Acceptance is winning the enrollment battle while dealer productivity has softened. That makes per-dealer yield a high-leverage product hypothesis to investigate: can reducing dealer workflow friction produce more funded deals from the existing base? At roughly 11,000 active dealers, even modest improvement can matter - but this is a working hypothesis to validate against internal cohort, profitability, and conversion data.

Where the friction is (dealer voice)

- Single-vehicle recommendation: CAPS returns the one vehicle it scores best; dealers want multiple financeable options from their inventory so they can sell what the customer actually wants.
- Double entry: dealers key deals into Dealertrack / RouteOne / DealerCenter, then re-enter or switch into CAPS to work the deal. Every re-key is a place to lose the deal to a lender already integrated in the dealer's desking tool.
- Internal prioritization is driven by EVA (economic value added) scoring, so dealer-experience improvements compete with pricing/collections work unless a PM can express them in EVA terms.

Competitive landscape

Competitive signals are included only to frame questions for Discovery. Public sources suggest several lenders reduce dealer friction through embedded desking workflows or broader vehicle-option tooling. The implications below are hypotheses, not claims about Credit Acceptance's internal roadmap or capability gaps.

Competitor / signal	Dealer advantage	Implication for Discovery	Confidence / source basis
Westlake Financial (private; owns DealerCenter DMS)	20,000+ dealer footprint; owns DealerCenter; integrated lender workflow; I-Maxx surfaces multiple financeable vehicles.	Discovery question: how much share loss is caused by workflow position and vehicle-option breadth versus economics?	High - public product and dealer materials
Santander Consumer USA (Chrysler Capital)	Large subprime scale and broad dealer relationships across credit tiers.	Discovery question: where does CAPS win or lose at the dealer desk when several lenders are compared side by side?	Medium - public market/peer sources

Credit Acceptance in that frame. Its durable advantages are the guaranteed-approval program with dealer holdback, the 30-second CAPS approval, and record dealer engagement. Its relative weaknesses are the two friction points above and a regulatory overhang: the [CFPB withdrew from the joint lawsuit in April 2025](#), and the remaining [New York Attorney General claims were settled in principle in June 2026](#). That history is why this program treats Compliance as a design partner from Sprint 0 rather than a gate at the end.

Why this fits the role. The JD asks for a customer-centric owner of end-to-end experience who improves business KPIs, understands integration points across product lines, and leads through influence across Sales, Analytics, Engineering, Legal, and Operations. The initiative below is designed to exercise every one of those competencies.

2. The hypothetical initiative

Working hypothesis to validate in Discovery. The initiative below is intentionally provisional. Internal data, dealer research, architecture constraints, EVA economics, and Compliance requirements should confirm, reshape, or replace it.

Field	Content
Initiative name	CAPS Dealer Yield Program
Product owned	CAPS 2.0 dealer origination platform (application → approval → structuring → contracting → funding)
Problem statement	Active dealers are at record levels, but average unit volume per active dealer is declining. Existing dealers are leaking deals to integrated competitors because of single-vehicle recommendations and duplicate data entry.
Hypothesis	If CAPS surfaces multiple financeable vehicle options and accepts applications directly from the dealer's desking tool, then approval-to-funding conversion and deals per dealer will rise, measured by average unit volume per active dealer among dealers active in both periods.
North-star KPI	Average unit volume per active dealer (same-period dealers): from 9.9 to 10.4 per quarter (+5%) within two quarters of full rollout
Supporting KPIs	Application-to-approval rate · Approval-to-funding rate · Median hours to fund · Deals restructured before funding · Dealer CSAT on CAPS · 90-day activation rate for newly enrolled dealers
Guardrail KPIs	Forecasted collection rate on originated vintages (no degradation) · Advance-rate compliance · Fair-lending/ECOA adverse-action accuracy · CAPS p95 approval latency ≤ 30s
Timeline	9 months: Oct 2026 – Jun 2027 (Discovery → Build → Pilot → Scale)
Team	1 Senior PM (owner) · 1 Product Analyst · 1 UX designer · 2 scrum teams (CAPS platform, Integrations) · Data Science partner · Sales enablement lead · Compliance partner

Three workstreams

#	Workstream	Dealer job-to-be-done	Deliverable
WS1	Multi-Vehicle Deal Options	"Show me every car on my lot this customer can drive home in today, and the deal on each."	CAPS returns a ranked set of financeable inventory options per approved applicant, each with advance, term, and payment
WS2	Desking-Tool Intake Integration	"Let me send the app from the tool I already use, and pick up the deal in CAPS without re-typing."	One-way application intake API; certified connectors for RouteOne and Dealertrack in Phase 1, DealerCenter in Phase 2
WS3	Dealer Yield Analytics & Enablement	"Tell my rep which dealers are slipping so we can intervene before they go dark."	Dealer Health Score (volume trend, approval-to-fund ratio, days since last funding) surfaced to Market Area Managers; playbooks and training

Out of scope

- Changes to the underwriting model, advance-rate logic, or pricing policy (owned by Analytics/Pricing; this program consumes their outputs)
- Consumer-facing portal and mobile app (separate product line)
- Collections and servicing platform changes

3. Product strategy

Customer definition

Segment	Who	What they optimize for	Current pain
Independent dealer F&I / desk manager	5–30 units/month, often single-location	Close the customer in the chair today	Re-keying; one-vehicle answer; switching lenders mid-deal
Franchise dealer special-finance manager	Higher volume, uses RouteOne/Dealertrack	Lender comparison inside the desking tool	CACC not in the comparison set unless he leaves the tool
Market Area Manager (internal)	Owns a dealer territory	Dealer retention and per-dealer volume	No early-warning signal on slipping dealers
Consumer (indirect)	Subprime buyer	A reliable car at a payment they can make	Told "the bank only approved this one"

Strategic choices

- **Sequence integration before UX.** WS2 (intake) is the larger EVA driver because it reaches franchise dealers already comparing lenders; WS1 (multi-vehicle) protects the independent base. Build the API in Sprint 1–4 while UX research for WS1 runs in parallel.
- **Frame everything in EVA.** The prioritization currency at Credit Acceptance is economic value. Every epic carries a modeled EVA estimate (incremental units × expected profit per unit – build cost), reviewed with Analytics before it enters the roadmap.
- **Hypothesis-driven rollout.** Pilot with 300 dealers (150 test / 150 matched control) for one full funding cycle before scaling. Ship-to-learn, not ship-to-finish.
- **Compliance as a design partner, not a gate.** Multi-vehicle options change the adverse-action and pricing disclosure surface; Legal/Compliance joins discovery in Sprint 0 rather than reviewing at the end.

Roadmap

Provisional roadmap - sequence and dates are working assumptions until Discovery establishes the real constraints and approved priorities.

Phase	Window	Outcome	Exit criteria
0 · Discovery & Alignment	Oct 2026 (4 wks)	Validated problem, EVA model, charter approved	Steering Committee sign-off; 20 dealer interviews complete; baseline KPIs frozen
1 · Build	Nov 2026 – Feb 2027 (8 sprints)	Intake API + RouteOne/Dealertrack connectors; multi-vehicle engine; Health Score v1	Feature-complete in staging; compliance review passed; partner certification scheduled
2 · Pilot	Mar – Apr 2027	300-dealer controlled pilot	Statistically significant lift in approval-to-fund or units/dealer; no guardrail breach
3 · Scale & Enablement	May – Jun 2027	National rollout; MAM playbooks; DealerCenter connector	≥ 80% of active dealers exposed; KPI dashboard live; process documented and handed to run-state

4. Stakeholder communication strategy & plan

Principle: every stakeholder group gets the smallest amount of communication that lets them make their decision or do their job, on a cadence they can predict, from one source of truth (the Jira project and its Confluence space). Product Management owns the plan; nobody learns about a change from a dealer before they learn it from us.

Stakeholder analysis (power / interest)

Stakeholder	Power	Interest	What they need from the program	Engagement approach
CPO / Executive Sponsor	High	High	EVA case, schedule confidence, guardrail status	Manage closely: monthly Steering Committee, ad-hoc escalation path
CFO / Finance	High	Medium	Capital and EVA impact, no surprise on collection rates	Keep satisfied: EVA re-forecast monthly, pilot readout
Chief Analytics / Pricing	High	High	Control of eligibility and pricing logic; instrumentation quality	Manage closely: design partner from Sprint 0
Legal & Compliance	High	High	Adverse-action, fair-lending, disclosure integrity	Manage closely: workshop in Discovery, sign-off gate before pilot
Head of Dealer Sales / MAM leadership	High	High	Dealer retention, territory volume, credible playbooks	Manage closely: bi-weekly; co-own dealer engagement plan
Engineering leads (CAPS, Integrations)	Medium	High	Clear priorities, stable scope, decisions within a sprint	Keep informed daily: sprint ceremonies, Jira as single backlog
InfoSec	Medium	Medium	Early API design visibility	Keep satisfied: review slot booked at kickoff
Dealer Service Center	Low	High	Training, scripts, defect route	Keep informed: release notes, pilot war-room channel
Funding Operations	Medium	Medium	Exception rules for restructured deals	Keep informed: pilot readiness review
Marketing	Low	Medium	Go decision, approved claims, launch dates	Keep informed: Phase 3 launch brief
Integration partners (RouteOne, Dealertrack, DealerCenter)	Medium	Medium	Spec stability, certification schedule	Keep satisfied: partner PM weekly during build/cert
Dealers (external customer)	Medium	High	A faster close and fewer re-keys; no disruption	See dealer engagement plan below

Communication plan

Audience	Message / content	Channel	Cadence	Owner
Executive Steering Committee	Program health (RAG), EVA re-forecast, decisions needed, guardrails	30-min steering meeting + 1-page brief (Confluence)	Monthly; gates at end of each phase	Senior PM
Analytics, Compliance, Sales leads (core team)	Progress vs. roadmap, open decisions, cross-team asks	Core team sync; Jira board review	Bi-weekly	Senior PM
Scrum teams	Priorities, acceptance criteria, demo feedback	Sprint planning, review, retro; Jira	Every sprint (2 wks); daily standup	Senior PM / Scrum Master
All internal stakeholders	Sprint demo recording + release notes	Email digest + Confluence release page	End of every sprint	Product Analyst
Dealer Service Center & Funding Ops	What is changing, scripts, known issues, escalation path	Training session + pilot war-room channel (Teams)	Before pilot; daily during pilot week 1, then weekly	Senior PM + DSC lead
Market Area Managers	Dealer Health Score how-to, pilot cohort, playbooks	MAM enablement session; weekly Health Score email	Before pilot; weekly thereafter	Sales Enablement
Integration partners	Spec changes, certification schedule, launch plan	Partner PM call; shared API docs	Weekly during build/cert; monthly after	Integrations lead
Marketing	Go decision, approved claims, launch assets needed	Launch brief	Once at go decision + weekly to launch	Senior PM
Company-wide	Milestone announcements (pilot launch, national rollout, results)	Internal newsletter / town hall slot	At milestones	Exec Sponsor

Escalation path: scrum team → Senior PM (same day) → core team lead (48 hours) → Steering Committee (next monthly or ad-hoc if a guardrail is breached). Decision log lives in Confluence and links to the Jira issue that triggered it.

Dealer engagement strategy & plan

Dealers are the customer this role advocates for. Engagement is designed so the program learns from dealers before build, proves value with dealers during pilot, and uses dealers' own voices to drive adoption at scale. The Sales organization co-owns this plan; Product owns the content and the feedback loop.

Phase	Objective	Activities	Dealers involved	Success signal
Discovery	Validate the two friction points and size the prize	20 structured interviews (10 independent, 10 franchise) ride-along with MAMs; 3 desk-side observations of a live deal; survey to 500 active dealers on desking-tool usage	~520	≥ 70% confirm re-keying or single-vehicle as a top-3 CAPS pain; desking-tool mix quantified
Build	Keep dealers in the design loop	Dealer Advisory Panel (8 dealers) reviews prototypes each sprint review; 2 usability sessions per major screen	8–12	Panel approval of multi-vehicle screen before code freeze
Pilot	Prove lift with a controlled cohort	150 test dealers (matched 150 control) recruited by MAMs; onboarding call with each test dealer; weekly 15-min check-in; war-room channel for issues; NPS pulse at week 2 and week 6	300	Statistically significant lift in approval-to-fund or units/dealer; CAPS CSAT up; no increase in support tickets per deal
Scale	Drive adoption across the network	Wave rollout by MAM territory; "dealers who did this" case stories in the launch campaign; MAM playbook with Health Score talk track; Dealer Service Center proactive outreach to slipping dealers	All active (~11,000)	≥ 80% of active dealers exposed; ≥ 50% of integrated-tool dealers submit via API within 60 days; Health Score interventions logged
Run-state	Sustain the feedback loop	Quarterly Dealer Advisory Panel; Health Score-driven outreach; in-CAPS feedback widget routed to Jira	Ongoing	Per-dealer volume trend among same-period dealers turns positive

Dealer messaging (approved by Compliance before use): "Send the application from the tool you already use, and see every car on your lot the customer can drive home in — same 30-second approval, one less place to lose the deal."

5. Proposed delivery operating model: Jira backlog & GitHub integration

Proposed operating model. If Jira Cloud and GitHub are the approved enterprise tools, I would use Jira as the planning and delivery system of record and connect engineering activity so status is evidence-based rather than manually reported. The example below shows the level of backlog structure, traceability, and dependency visibility I would establish - not a claim about Credit Acceptance's current tooling or configuration.

Epics

Key	Epic	Workstream	Sprints	EVA lens
CDY-1	Discovery: dealer research, JTBD, baseline metrics	All	0	Defines the prize
CDY-2	Application Intake API (canonical app schema, auth, idempotency, error handling)	WS2	1–4	Enables all connectors
CDY-3	RouteOne connector & certification	WS2	3–6	Franchise reach
CDY-4	Dealertrack connector & certification	WS2	4–7	Franchise reach
CDY-5	Multi-Vehicle Option Engine (inventory ingest, eligibility scoring, ranking)	WS1	2–6	Independent-dealer close rate
CDY-6	CAPS UI: option comparison, restructure flow, disclosures	WS1	5–8	Conversion
CDY-8	Dealer Health Score v1 + MAM dashboard	WS3	5–8	Retention
CDY-9	Pilot design, instrumentation, and analysis	All	8–12	Proves the hypothesis

Sample stories (format used throughout)

Key	User story	Acceptance criteria (abridged)
CDY-2.3	As a desking-tool partner, I can POST an application to /v1/applications and receive a CAPS application ID within 2s, so the dealer never re-keys the app.	Schema validated · duplicate submissions idempotent by partner ref · 4xx errors return field-level messages · p95 ≤ 2s at 50 rps · audit log written
CDY-5.4	As a desk manager, when a customer is approved I see up to 5 vehicles from my inventory that qualify, ranked by expected profitability and customer fit, each with advance, term, and payment.	Only vehicles meeting advance/eligibility rules shown · ranking explainable on hover · refresh ≤ 3s · falls back to single-vehicle view if inventory feed is stale > 24h

Definition of Ready: JTBD stated · acceptance criteria testable · EVA estimate attached to parent epic · compliance impact flagged · dependencies linked. **Definition of Done:** code merged and deployed to staging · automated tests pass · compliance checklist signed · analytics events verified · release note drafted.

GitHub integration: development progress tracked automatically

Illustrative GitHub integration. In this proposed model, repositories map cleanly to product components and Jira issues connect to branches, pull requests, tests, and deployments. The objective is one traceable flow from user story to production evidence, while allowing Engineering to use the repository structure and automation standards it already supports.

Mechanism	Rule	What the PM sees in Jira
Pull requests	PR title includes the issue key; opening a PR moves the story to In Review; merge moves it to Done via Jira Automation	PR state, reviewers, and checks visible on the story; no manual status changes
Deployments	GitHub Actions posts deployment events (staging, pilot, prod) to Jira	Release readiness per story and per epic; pilot go/no-go uses this view
Jira Automation	If all sub-tasks Done → story to Ready for QA; if PR merged and QA passed → Done; if a Guardrail Impact = Y story changes status → notify Compliance lead	Rules replace status meetings

Why this matters for the role: the JD asks the PM to own delivery on time and with quality. With this setup the sprint review is about the product, not the ticket hygiene, and the Steering Committee brief is generated from live data.

6. Delivery plan & timeline (Jira Plans)

Illustrative delivery plan. The timeline shows how I would make sequencing, ownership, and cross-department dependencies visible if Jira Plans is the approved planning tool. Dates and sprint counts are placeholders to pressure-test the operating model; Discovery and team capacity would establish the committed plan.

Phase	Work item (Jira type)	Sprints / window	Depends on	Owner dept
0	Discovery epic CDY-1: interviews, baseline KPIs, EVA model, compliance workshop, partner scoping	Sprint 0 (4 wks, Oct)	—	Product, Analytics, Compliance, Integrations
0	Milestone: Steering Committee approval	End Oct	CDY-1	Exec Sponsor
1	CDY-2 Intake API	Sprints 1–4	SC approval	Integrations Eng
1	InfoSec review (task under CDY-2)	Sprints 3–4	CDY-2 design	InfoSec
1	CDY-3 RouteOne connector	Sprints 3–6	CDY-2	Integrations Eng
1	CDY-4 Dealertrack connector	Sprints 4–7	CDY-2	Integrations Eng
1	Partner certification (tasks under CDY-3/4)	Sprints 7–8	CDY-3, CDY-4, InfoSec	Partners
1	CDY-5 Multi-Vehicle Option Engine	Sprints 2–6	SC approval; rules from Analytics	CAPS Eng, Data Science
1	CDY-6 CAPS UI: options, restructure, disclosures	Sprints 5–8	CDY-5	CAPS Eng, UX
1	CDY-7 Compliance & disclosure changes	Sprints 2–8	Compliance workshop; CDY-5	CAPS Eng, Compliance
1	Milestone: Compliance sign-off	End Sprint 8	CDY-7	Legal/Compliance
1	CDY-8 Dealer Health Score + MAM dashboard	Sprints 5–8	Baseline KPIs	Data Science, BI
1	Milestone: Build complete	End Sprint 8 (late Feb)	CDY-6, cert, sign-off, CDY-8	Product
2	CDY-9 Pilot: cohort selection, DSC training, launch, run, analysis	Sprints 9–12 (Mar–Apr)	Build complete	Product, Analytics, Sales, DSC, Funding Ops
2	Milestone: Go / No-Go	End Apr	CDY-9 readout	Steering Committee
3	Wave rollout (release tasks under CDY-6/CDY-3/CDY-4)	Sprints 13–15	Go decision	Engineering, Sales
3	CDY-10 Enablement: playbooks, campaign, DSC scripts	Sprints 13–15	Go decision; Compliance claims approval	Sales Enablement, Marketing
3	CDY-11 DealerCenter connector	Sprints 13–16	Go decision	Integrations Eng
3	Run-state handoff & documentation (task)	Sprint 16	Rollout, CDY-10	Product
3	Milestone: Program close & KPI review	End Jun 2027	All	Exec Sponsor

Critical path: Discovery → SC approval → Intake API → connectors → partner certification → build complete → pilot → go/no-go → wave rollout → close. Partner certification is the highest schedule risk because third parties control it; certification windows are booked in Sprint 0 and tracked as a dependency in Jira Plans.

7. Tools in scope

Illustrative toolset: use the enterprise-standard tools already approved by Credit Acceptance; the products named below demonstrate the workflow, not a required stack.

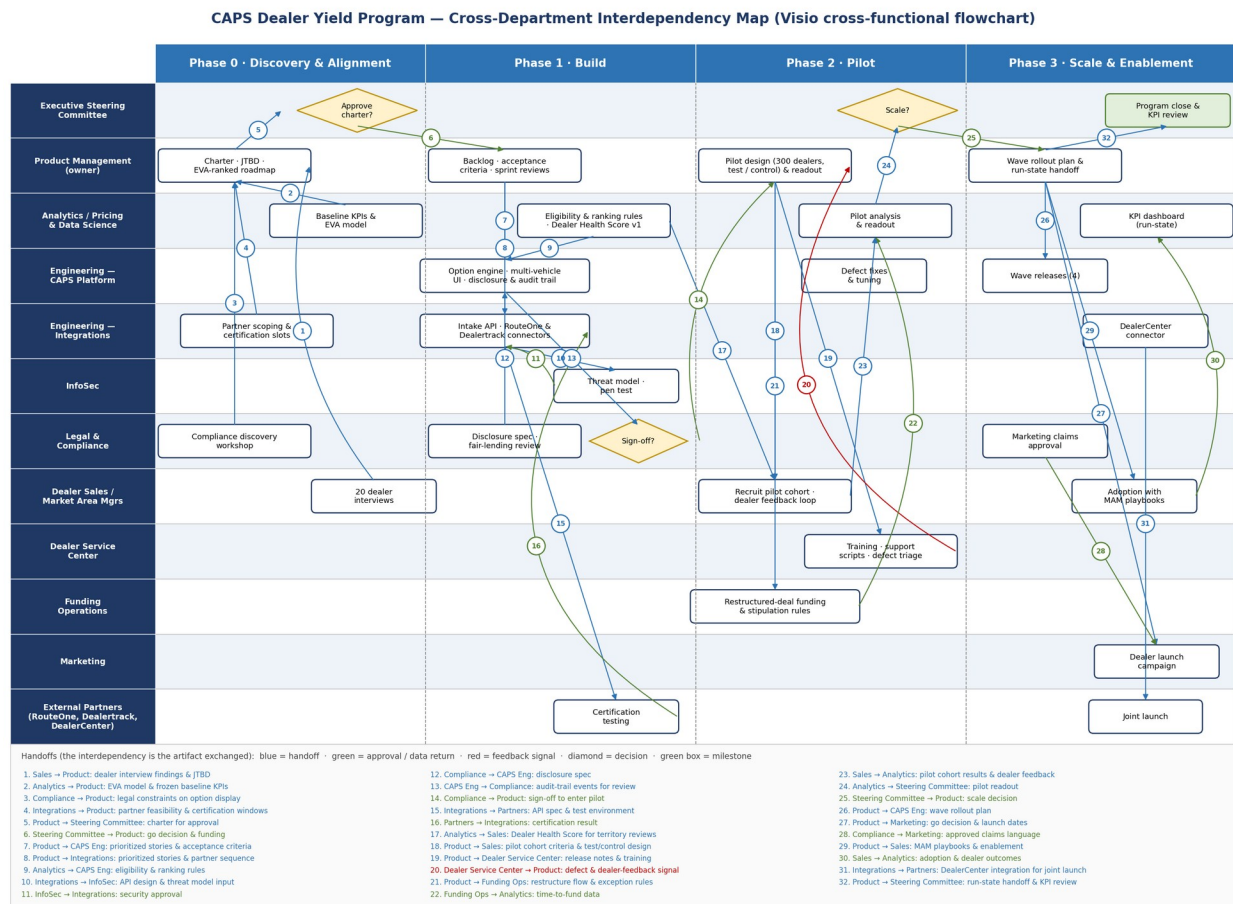
Purpose	Tool	How it is used on this program
Planning, backlog, delivery tracking	Jira Cloud (Software) + Jira Plans	Single system of record: epics, stories, sprints, timeline, dependencies, dashboards for Steering Committee
Source control & engineering progress	GitHub (org, repos, Actions) integrated with Jira	Branches, PRs, deployments, and engineering-found issues flow into Jira automatically (Section 5)
Diagrams	Microsoft Visio	Cross-functional flowchart (Diagram A), current/future deal flow (Diagram B), integration context (Diagram C); exported to Confluence and the steering brief
Documentation & decisions	Confluence	Charter, decision log, release notes, pilot readout; linked from Jira
Discovery & design collaboration	Miro; Figma	JTBD mapping and journey maps; multi-vehicle screen prototypes

Purpose	Tool	How it is used on this program
		reviewed by Dealer Advisory Panel
Data & KPI reporting	Tableau (or existing BI stack)	Baseline and pilot KPIs, Dealer Health Score dashboard for MAMs
API design & partner testing	OpenAPI spec; Postman collections	Shared with RouteOne / Dealertrack / DealerCenter for certification
Communication	Microsoft Teams; email digest	Core-team channel, pilot war-room, sprint demo digest

8. Diagrams (designed for MS Visio)

Each diagram is an illustrative working model built from public information. In Discovery I would redraw these with internal SMEs so the actual handoffs, controls, systems, and decision rights replace the assumptions shown here.

Diagram A — Cross-department interdependency map (cross-functional flowchart, swimlanes)



Layout: horizontal swimlanes, one per department, phases as vertical bands (Discovery · Build · Pilot · Scale). Shapes: rounded rectangle = activity, diamond = decision, document shape = artifact handed across lanes. Connector labels state what is exchanged, because the interdependency is the artifact, not the arrow.

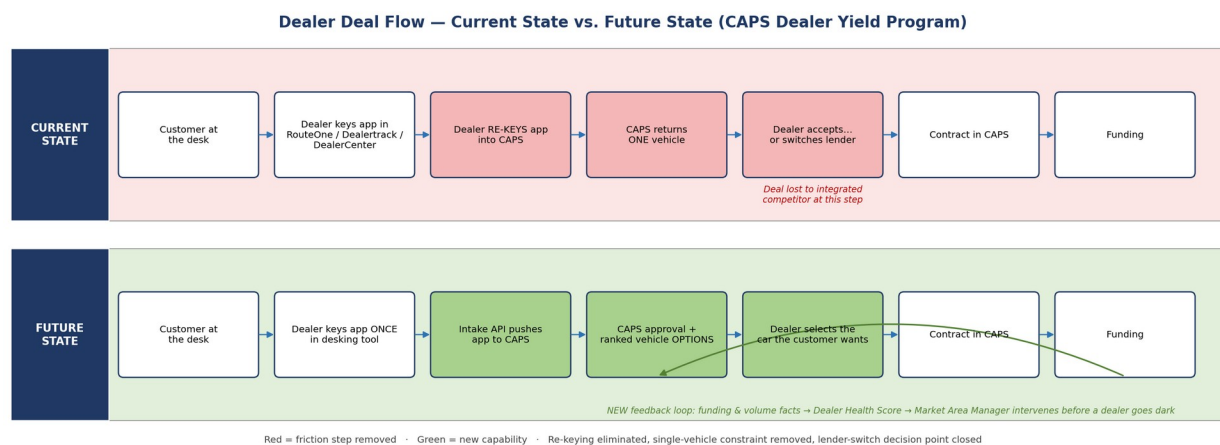
Swimlane	Key activities	Provides to others	Depends on
Product Management (owner)	Charter, roadmap, backlog, pilot design, go/no-go	Prioritized backlog; acceptance criteria; KPI targets	EVA model (Analytics); dealer insight (Sales); legal constraints (Compliance)
Analytics / Pricing & Data Science	Baseline KPIs, EVA model, eligibility rules, Health Score, pilot analysis	Eligibility & advance-rate rules; EVA estimates; pilot readout	Event instrumentation (Engineering); dealer segments (Sales)
Engineering — CAPS Platform	Inventory ingest, option engine, UI, disclosures	Working software in staging/prod; analytics events	Rules (Analytics); designs (UX); disclosure specs (Compliance)

Swimlane	Key activities	Provides to others	Depends on
Engineering — Integrations	Intake API, RouteOne/Dealertrack/DealerCenter connectors	Certified connectors; partner docs	API security approval (InfoSec); partner test environments (Partners)
InfoSec	API threat model, pen test, data-handling review	Security approval	API design (Integrations)
Legal & Compliance	Adverse-action, pricing disclosure, fair-lending review, audit trail	Compliance sign-off; disclosure copy	Option-display design (Product/UX); audit events (Engineering)
Dealer Sales / Market Area Managers	Dealer interviews, pilot recruitment, rollout, adoption	Dealer feedback; pilot cohort; adoption	Health Score (Analytics); playbooks (Enablement)
Dealer Service Center	Front-line dealer support and issue triage	Support scripts; defect signal	Training (Enablement); release notes (Product)
Funding Operations	Contract and stipulation verification on restructured deals	Funding-time metrics; exception rules	Restructure flow design (Product)
Marketing	Dealer communication, launch campaign	Launch comms; enrollment messaging	Go/no-go (Product); claims approval (Compliance)
External Partners (RouteOne, Dealertrack, DealerCenter)	Certification testing, joint launch	Certified integration; co-marketing	API spec and test env (Integrations)
Executive Steering Committee	Charter approval, funding, go/no-go	Decisions; resourcing	Readouts (Product/Analytics)

Cross-lane connectors to draw (label each):

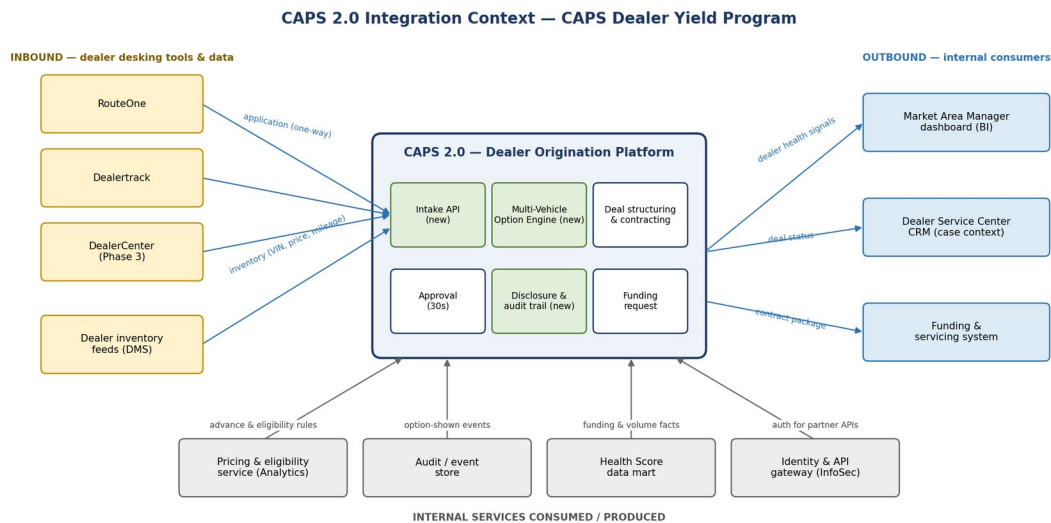
- Analytics → Product: EVA model & baseline KPIs (Discovery)
- Sales → Product: dealer interview findings (Discovery)
- Product → Steering Committee: charter → decision diamond "Approve?"
- Analytics → CAPS Eng: eligibility & ranking rules (Build)
- Compliance → CAPS Eng: disclosure spec; CAPS Eng → Compliance: audit events → decision diamond "Sign-off?"
- Integrations Eng → InfoSec: API design; InfoSec → Integrations Eng: security approval
- Integrations Eng ↔ Partners: spec / test env / certification result
- Analytics → Sales: Dealer Health Score (Build → Pilot)
- Product → Dealer Service Center: release notes & training; DSC → Product: defect and dealer-feedback signal (Pilot)
- Product → Funding Ops: restructure flow; Funding Ops → Analytics: time-to-fund data (Pilot)
- Analytics → Steering Committee: pilot readout → decision diamond "Scale?"
- Product → Marketing: go decision; Compliance → Marketing: claims approval (Scale)

Diagram B — End-to-end deal flow, current vs. future (basic flowchart, two lanes)



Build notes: top lane (current): Customer at desk → Dealer keys app in deskings tool → Dealer re-keys in CAPS → CAPS returns one vehicle → Dealer accepts or switches lender → Contract → Funding. Bottom lane (future): Customer at desk → Dealer keys app once in deskings tool → Intake API → CAPS approval with ranked vehicle options → Dealer selects → Contract → Funding; Health Score loop back to Market Area Manager. Highlight removed steps in red and new steps in green — this is the one-slide story for the interview.

Diagram C — Integration context diagram (block diagram)



Build notes: CAPS 2.0 at center; inbound: RouteOne, Dealertrack, DealerCenter (via Intake API), dealer inventory feeds; internal: pricing/eligibility service, disclosure service, audit store, Health Score data mart; outbound: MAM dashboard, Dealer Service Center CRM, funding system. Useful for the "integration mind-set" requirement in the JD.

9. RAID starter register

Type	Item	Response	Owner
Risk	Partner certification slips (third-party controlled, on critical path)	Book certification windows in Phase 0; build against partner sandbox early; DealerCenter deferred to Phase 3 to protect Phase 1	Integrations Eng
Risk	Multi-vehicle options shift mix toward lower-margin units or degrade collection rates	Ranking optimizes expected profit, not price; Analytics monitors vintage performance weekly during pilot; kill switch to single-vehicle view	Analytics
Risk	Fair-lending / adverse-action exposure from showing differentiated options	Compliance in discovery; immutable option log; disclosure copy approved before pilot	Legal/Compliance
Risk	EVA prioritization deprioritizes the program mid-flight	Every epic carries an EVA estimate; monthly EVA re-forecast to Steering Committee	Product
Assumption	Dealer inventory feeds are available for $\geq 70\%$ of active dealers via existing DMS relationships	Validate in Discovery; fallback is manual VIN entry	Product
Issue	Baseline KPI definitions differ between Sales and Finance reporting	Freeze definitions in Phase 0 with Analytics as arbiter	Analytics
Dependency	InfoSec review capacity in Nov–Dec	Request slot at kickoff; SS+15 overlap already in plan	Product

10. First 30 Days — Validate or Replace the Hypothesis

The first 30 days are for learning the enterprise before changing it. The purpose is not to defend the hypothetical initiative in this document; it is to test it. Two tracks run in parallel: required HR/Compliance learning and an Enterprise Analysis that establishes the business need, current-state capability, constraints, and evidence-based solution scope. By Day 30, the CAPS Dealer Yield hypothesis should be confirmed, materially revised, or replaced by a better one.

10.1 Objectives and Day-30 deliverables

Objective	Deliverable by Day 30
Be compliant and credentialed to work with consumer and dealer data	All required HR, compliance, and security training complete; system access provisioned
Understand the enterprise as a system: laws, departments, leadership, products, systems, people	Enterprise Analysis brief (10–12 pages) covering the six domains in A.3
Establish working relationships with every department the product touches	Stakeholder map with role, influence, interest, and first-meeting notes for 25+ people
Validate or replace the product hypothesis	Business need statement, capability gap assessment, and a prioritized problem list with EVA framing
Earn the right to run the program	Day-30 readout to CPO with recommended 60/90-day plan and charter draft

10.2 Track 1 — HR & Compliance training

Modules are those typically required at an indirect auto lender; the actual curriculum comes from HR and Compliance. Completing them in week 1–2 is a prerequisite for handling dealer and consumer data in weeks 2–4.

Area	Training module	Why it matters to this role	Target
HR & culture	New-hire orientation; company values (Positive, Respectful, Insightful, Direct, Earnest); Code of Conduct; anti-harassment; benefits enrollment	Sets expectations for how product decisions are communicated and escalated	Week 1
Information security	Security awareness; acceptable use; data classification; phishing; device and remote-work policy	PM handles NPI and dealer data daily; remote role	Week 1
Privacy	GLBA privacy and safeguards; state privacy laws (e.g., CCPA); data retention	Consumer data flows through CAPS and any new integration	Week 1
Fair lending	ECOA / Regulation B; fair-lending principles; disparate impact; adverse-action notices	Multi-vehicle options and ranking logic change what consumers are offered	Week 1–2
Consumer credit disclosure	TILA / Regulation Z; UDAAP (Dodd-Frank §1031/1036); state retail installment sales acts	Every option shown to a dealer is a disclosure surface	Week 2
Credit reporting	FCRA; permissible purpose; dispute handling	Applications pulled via deskings tools must preserve permissible purpose	Week 2
Collections & servicing	FDCPA principles; state collection laws; SCRA; TCPA	Understand downstream impact of originations on servicing	Week 2
Financial crime	BSA / AML; OFAC screening; red-flags (identity theft) program	Intake integration must not weaken identity and fraud controls	Week 2
Vendor & third-party risk	Third-party risk management policy; vendor onboarding	RouteOne, Dealertrack, and DealerCenter are third parties	Week 2
Company-specific	Dealer program guidelines; CAPS user training; regulatory exam and litigation history briefing from Legal	Direct context for the product and its constraints	Week 2–3

10.3 Track 2 — Enterprise Analysis (BABOK)

Following the BABOK Enterprise Analysis / Strategy Analysis tasks — analyze the current state, define the business need, assess capability gaps, determine the solution approach, define solution scope, and define the business case — applied across six domains of the enterprise. Techniques: document analysis, interviews, observation, process modeling, organizational modeling, SWOT, root-cause analysis, and stakeholder analysis.

Domain	What to learn	Techniques & sources	Artifact produced
1. Laws & regulations governing business activities	External: federal (ECOA, TILA, FCRA, UDAAP, GLBA, FDCPA, SCRA, TCPA, BSA/AML) and state (licensing, retail installment, usury, collection, privacy) rules that govern origination, funding, servicing, and marketing workflows; open regulatory matters. Internal: policies, program guidelines, credit and pricing policy, model governance, change-control, disclosure approval process, exam findings	Document analysis of policies and 10-K/10-Q risk factors; interviews with Chief Compliance Officer, General Counsel, model-risk lead; walk one application from submission to funding and mark every control point	Regulatory & policy matrix: each workflow step × the laws/policies that govern it × the internal control × the owning department
2. Departments	How Sales / Market Area Managers, Dealer Service Center, Funding Operations, Collections & Servicing, Analytics & Pricing, Engineering, Compliance, Legal, Finance, Marketing, and HR are organized; their KPIs; their hand-offs; where work queues and exceptions form	Organizational modeling; process modeling of the end-to-end dealer and consumer journeys; observation (ride-along with a MAM, a shift in the Dealer Service Center, a day in Funding)	Cross-department value-stream map with hand-offs, cycle times, and pain points; department KPI sheet
3. Leadership	CEO agenda and transformation priorities; CPO product strategy and roadmap; CFO EVA framework and capital priorities; Chief Sales Officer dealer strategy; Chief Transformation Officer initiatives; Steering Committee structure and decision rights	Interviews; review of earnings materials, strategy decks, and OKRs; observe a Steering Committee or prioritization meeting	Leadership priority map: each leader's top three outcomes and how CAPS Dealer Yield serves or conflicts with them; decision-rights (RACI) for product changes
4. Products	Dealer Loan vs. Purchased Loan programs and their economics; advance rates and holdback; consumer products and payment channels; CAPS 2.0 feature set and roadmap; dealer enrollment and engagement products; pricing tiers	Document analysis of program guidelines and product docs; hands-on use of CAPS in a training environment; review of dealer-facing collateral; competitive teardown (Westlake I-Maxx, DealerCenter, Dealertrack lender experience)	Product inventory and capability map; competitive gap list ranked by dealer impact
5. Systems & tools	CAPS 2.0 architecture and integrations; pricing/eligibility engine; servicing platform; data warehouse and BI; DMS/desking-tool connections; Jira/GitHub/Confluence usage; dealer-facing portal and support CRM; model deployment pipeline	Architecture walkthrough with Engineering; data-lineage session with Analytics; review of integration inventory and SLAs; identify instrumentation gaps for the KPIs in Section 2	System landscape diagram (Visio) with owners, integration points, and known constraints; KPI instrumentation gap list
6. People	Who actually makes things happen: informal influencers, subject-matter experts, longest-tenured operators, the engineers who know CAPS best, the MAMs dealers trust, the Compliance partner who can say yes; working norms, communication preferences, and history of prior initiatives	Stakeholder analysis; 25+ one-on-ones (structured, 30 minutes, same five questions); listening for repeated names; shadowing	Stakeholder map (power / interest / attitude) with engagement approach; list of five allies and three likely objectors with their concerns

10.4 Week-by-week plan

Week	Focus	Key activities	Output
Week 1 (Days 1–5)	Orientation, compliance, first relationships	Complete HR, InfoSec, privacy, and fair-lending training; system access; meet manager, product peers, and scrum teams; read 10-K, 10-Q, last four earnings transcripts, dealer program guidelines; schedule the 25 one-on-ones	Training complete; reading notes; interview schedule; draft interview guide
Week 2 (Days 6–10)	Laws, policies, and the current-state workflow	Finish compliance modules; Compliance and Legal interviews; walk one application end-to-end through CAPS with a Funding analyst; begin regulatory & policy matrix; CAPS hands-on in training environment	Regulatory & policy matrix v1; annotated end-to-end deal flow (current state)
Week 3 (Days 11–17)	Departments, systems, and leadership	Ride-along with a Market Area Manager and two dealer visits; Dealer Service Center shift; Funding Operations day; architecture and data-lineage walkthroughs; interviews with CPO, CFO or Finance lead, Chief Sales Officer, Analytics lead; competitive teardown	Value-stream map; system landscape diagram; leadership priority map; department KPI sheet
Week 4 (Days 18–24)	People, capability gaps, and business need	Complete one-on-ones; stakeholder map; gap assessment against dealer jobs-to-be-done; root-cause analysis of per-dealer volume decline using Analytics data; validate or revise hypothesis; EVA framing with Analytics	Stakeholder map; capability gap assessment; business need statement; prioritized problem list
Days 25–30	Synthesis and readout	Write the Enterprise Analysis brief; draft charter for the highest-value initiative; propose 60/90-day plan; Day-30 readout to CPO; publish brief to Confluence	Enterprise Analysis brief; charter draft; 60/90-day plan; readout deck

10.5 Interview guide (same five questions for every one-on-one)

- What does your team do, and how do you know when it is going well?

- Where does work get stuck between your team and another team?
- What do dealers or consumers complain about that we have not fixed, and why not?
- What rule, policy, or system constraint should a product manager understand before proposing changes to CAPS?
- Who else should I talk to?

10.6 Day-30 success criteria

Criterion	Evidence
Credentialed	100% of assigned HR, compliance, and security training complete; production read access to KPI data and CAPS training environment granted
Enterprise understood	Six domain artifacts in A.3 delivered and reviewed by at least one owner from each domain
Relationships established	25+ one-on-ones complete; stakeholder map reviewed with manager; a standing bi-weekly with Analytics, Compliance, and Sales leads set up
Hypothesis tested	Business need statement backed by internal data; hypothesis confirmed, revised, or replaced with rationale
Ready to lead	Charter draft and 60/90-day plan accepted by CPO as the basis for Phase 0

Why an enterprise analysis before a roadmap. *The hypothetical project in this document is built from public information. Thirty days inside the company will show where it is right and where it is wrong. Doing the analysis first is how a product manager earns the authority to change the product.*

What this package is meant to demonstrate

This is not a claim that I know Credit Acceptance better than the people inside it. It is evidence of how I work: find the signal, frame the customer problem, make the economics explicit, translate strategy into an executable backlog, expose dependencies early, and validate assumptions before scaling. The specific initiative may change after thirty days inside the business. The operating discipline would not.

What stays human. Research, drafts, analysis, and diagrams can be accelerated with AI. Choosing which problem deserves attention, deciding what evidence is sufficient, making the trade-offs across customer value, economics, risk, and compliance, and standing behind the recommendation remain human judgment calls.

The product hypothesis is intentionally provisional. The accountability for how it is validated, prioritized, communicated, and delivered is not.